

Linear Algebra – MAT 2610

Section 1.1

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What is a Linear Equation?

$$\underline{a_1x_1 + a_2x_2 + \cdots + a_nx_n = b}$$

where b and the coefficients $a_1, \dots, a_n$ are real or complex numbers (we will only use real numbers in this course)

$$3x_1 + 4x_2 - 3x_3 + \sqrt{41}x_4 = 27/17$$

$$3x_1 = 27/17 - 4x_2 + 3x_3 - \sqrt{41}x_4$$



A System of Linear Equations

This is a collection of one or more linear equations involving the same variables.

$$\begin{cases} 2x_1 + 3x_2 + 7x_3 = 18 \\ -2x_1 + 2x_3 = 0 \\ x_2 = 3 \end{cases}$$

System with
3 equations
in 3 variables



A Solution to a System of Linear Equations

This is a list $(s_1, s_2, \dots, s_n)$ of numbers that makes each equation a true statement when substituted for the variables $(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)$ respectively.

→
$$\begin{aligned} 2x_1 + 3x_2 + 7x_3 &= 18 \\ -2x_1 + 2x_3 &= 0 \\ x_2 &= 3 \end{aligned}$$
 → $(1, 3, 1)$ substituted for (x_1, x_2, x_3) makes each equation true.

$2(1) + 3(3) + 7(1) = 2 + 9 + 7 = 18$ ✓
 $-2(1) + 2(1) = -2 + 2 = 0$ ✓



A Solution Set

The collection of all possible solutions to a linear system is called a **solution set**.

Two linear systems are **equivalent** if they have the same solution set.



Solution Set Examples

$$\begin{aligned} 2x_1 + 3x_2 &= 11 \\ -2x_1 + 2x_2 &= -6 \end{aligned}$$

Has a single solution $(x_1, x_2) = (4, 1)$.

$$\begin{aligned} 2(4) + 3(1) &= 8 + 3 = 11 \quad \checkmark \\ -2(4) + 2(1) &= -8 + 2 = -6 \quad \checkmark \end{aligned}$$



Solution Set Examples

$$x_1 + 4x_2 = 8$$

$$2x_1 - x_2 = 7$$

Also has a single solution $(x_1, x_2) = (4, 1)$.

$$(4) + 4(1) = 4 + 4 = 8$$

$$2(4) - (1) = 8 - 1 = 7$$



Solution Set Examples

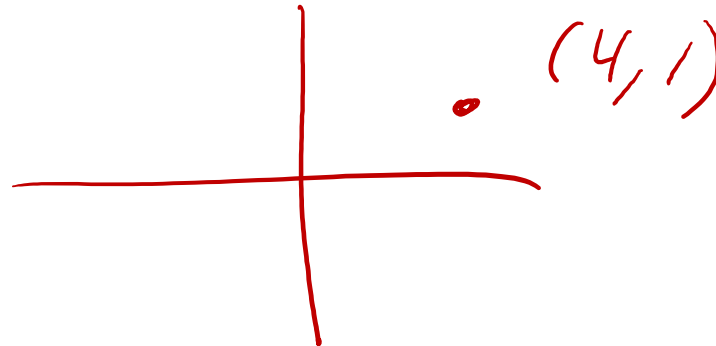
Notice that these two systems of linear equations

$$\begin{aligned} 2x_1 + 3x_2 &= 11 \\ -2x_1 + 2x_2 &= -6 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} x_1 + 4x_2 &= 8 \\ 2x_1 - x_2 &= 7 \end{aligned}$$

are quite different but both have the same solution set

$(x_1, x_2) = (4, 1)$. These two systems are equivalent.



Consistent

A system of linear equations is said to be **consistent** if it has at least one solution.

If not, it is **inconsistent**.

A system of linear equations has

1. No solution, or *inconsistent*
2. Exactly one solution, or
3. Infinitely many solutions.

consistent



Matrix

A **matrix** is a rectangular array of numbers

A matrix with m rows and n columns is referred to as an **m by n matrix** (or **m x n matrix**)

We say that an $m \times n$ matrix has **size** m by n

Note that the number of rows is always given first

$$\begin{bmatrix} 3 & 3 \\ -2 & 2 \\ 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \text{ is a } \underline{3 \times 2 \text{ matrix}}$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 4 & -2 & -2 \\ 5 & -1 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \text{ is a } \underline{2 \times 3 \text{ matrix}}$$



Matrix Notation

If we have:

$$x_1 + 3x_2 + 2x_3 = 13$$

$$2x_1 + 3x_2 - x_3 = 5$$

$$2x_1 - x_3 = 5$$

$$\begin{matrix} & x_1 & x_2 & x_3 \\ \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 2 \\ 2 & 3 & -1 \\ 2 & 0 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \end{matrix}$$

The matrix $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 2 \\ 2 & 3 & -1 \\ 2 & 0 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$ is called the coefficient matrix.

If we add in another column, consisting of the constants, we get the

matrix $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 2 & 13 \\ 2 & 3 & -1 & 5 \\ 2 & 0 & -1 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$. This is the augmented matrix.



Solving The System

$$x_1 + 3x_2 + 2x_3 = 13$$

$$2x_1 + 3x_2 - x_3 = 5$$

$$2x_1 + x_3 = 5$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 2 & 13 \\ 2 & 3 & -1 & 5 \\ 2 & 0 & 1 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$$

Eliminate x_1 from the second equation using the first

$$- \quad x_1 + 3x_2 + 2x_3 = 13$$

$$- \quad 2x_1 + 3x_2 - x_3 = 5$$

$\times 2$

$$2x_1 + 6x_2 + 4x_3 = 26$$

$$\rightarrow [-] \quad 2x_1 + 3x_2 - x_3 = 5$$

$$3x_2 + 5x_3 = 21$$



Solving The System (2)

$$x_1 + 3x_2 + 2x_3 = 13$$

$$3x_2 + 5x_3 = 21$$

$$2x_1 + x_3 = 5$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 2 & 13 \\ 0 & 3 & 5 & 21 \\ 2 & 0 & 1 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$$

Eliminate x_1 from the third equation using the first

$$x_1 + 3x_2 + 2x_3 = 13$$

$$2x_1 + x_3 = 5$$

$\times 2$

$$2x_1 + 6x_2 + 4x_3 = 26$$

$$2x_1 + x_3 = 5$$

$$6x_2 + 3x_3 = 21$$



Solving The System (3)

$$x_1 + 3x_2 + 2x_3 = 13$$

$$3x_2 + 5x_3 = 21$$

$$6x_2 + 3x_3 = 21$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 2 & 13 \\ 0 & 3 & 5 & 21 \\ 0 & 6 & 3 & 21 \end{bmatrix}$$

Eliminate x_2 from the third equation using the second

$$3x_2 + 5x_3 = 21$$

$$6x_2 + 3x_3 = 21$$

$\times 2$

$$6x_2 + 10x_3 = 42$$

$$6x_2 + 3x_3 = 21$$

$$7x_3 = 21$$



Solving The System (4)

$$x_1 + 3x_2 + 2x_3 = 13$$

$$3x_2 + 5x_3 = 21$$

$$7x_3 = 21$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 2 & 13 \\ 0 & 3 & 5 & 21 \\ 0 & 0 & 7 & 21 \end{bmatrix}$$

Now notice we can easily find the value for x_3

$$7x_3 = 21$$

$$x_3 = 3$$



Solving The System (5)

$$x_1 + 3x_2 + 2x_3 = 13$$

$$3x_2 + 5x_3 = 21$$

$$x_3 = 3$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 2 & 13 \\ 0 & 5 & 5 & 21 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$$

Using the value for x_3 we can solve for x_2

$$3x_2 + 5(3) = 21$$

$$3x_2 + 15 = 21$$

$$3x_2 = 6$$

$$x_2 = 2$$



Solving The System (6)

$$\rightarrow x_1 + 3x_2 + 2x_3 = 13$$

$$x_2 = 2$$

$$x_3 = 3$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 2 & 13 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$$

Using the value for x_2 and x_3 we can solve for x_1

$$x_1 + 3(2) + 2(3) = 13$$

$$x_1 + 6 + 6 = 13$$

$$x_1 + 12 = 13$$

$$x_1 = 1$$



Solving The System (7)

$$x_1 = 1$$

$$x_2 = 2$$

$$x_3 = 3$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$$

Check your work !!

$$x_1 + 3x_2 + 2x_3 = 13$$

$$2x_1 + 3x_2 - x_3 = 5$$

$$2x_1 + x_3 = 5$$

$$1 + 3(2) + 2(3) = 1 + 6 + 6 = 13$$

$$2(1) + 3(2) - (3) = 2 + 6 - 3 = 5$$

$$2(1) + (3) = 5$$



Elementary Row Operations

1. Add a multiple of one row to another row:

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 2 \\ 2 & 1 & -1 \\ 2 & 0 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \rightarrow \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 2 \\ 4 & 7 & 3 \\ 2 & 0 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \quad (\underline{2r_1} + \underline{r_2} \rightarrow \underline{r_2})$$

2. Interchange any two rows of the matrix:

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 2 \\ 2 & 1 & -1 \\ 2 & 0 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \rightarrow \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 2 \\ 2 & 0 & 3 \\ 2 & 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \quad (\underline{r_2} \leftrightarrow \underline{r_3})$$

3. Multiply every entry of some row by some nonzero scalar:

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 2 \\ 2 & 1 & -1 \\ 2 & 0 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \rightarrow \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 2 \\ 6 & 3 & -3 \\ 2 & 0 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \quad (\underline{3r_2} \rightarrow \underline{r_2})$$



Elementary Row Operations (2)

Any two matrices are called **row equivalent** if there is a sequence of elementary row operations that transforms one matrix into the other.

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 2 & 13 \\ 2 & 3 & -1 & 5 \\ 2 & 0 & 1 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$$

is row equivalent to

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\begin{aligned} x_1 + 0x_2 + 0x_3 &= 1 \\ 0x_1 + x_2 + 0x_3 &= 2 \\ 0x_1 + 0x_2 + x_3 &= 3 \end{aligned}$$

It is important to note that elementary row operations are reversible.

If the augmented matrices of two linear systems are row equivalent, then the two systems have the same solution set.



Example:

$$\begin{array}{rcl} & \downarrow & \downarrow & \downarrow \\ 2x + y - z & = & 2 \\ x + 3y + 2z & = & 1 \\ x + y - z & = & 2 \end{array}$$

Solve

$$\begin{array}{cccc} & x & y & z & \text{const} \\ \left[\begin{array}{cccc} 2 & 1 & -1 & 2 \\ 1 & 3 & 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & -1 & 2 \end{array} \right] \end{array}$$



$$\begin{array}{c} x_1 \\ \left[\begin{array}{cccc} 2 & 1 & -1 & 2 \\ 1 & 3 & 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & -1 & 2 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_1 - 2r_2 \rightarrow r_2} \left[\begin{array}{cccc} 2 & 1 & -1 & 2 \\ 2-2(1) & 1-2(3) & -1-2(2) & 2-2(1) \\ 1 & 1 & -1 & 2 \end{array} \right] = \left[\begin{array}{cccc} 2 & 1 & -1 & 2 \\ 0 & -5 & -5 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & -1 & 2 \end{array} \right] \end{array}$$

$$\downarrow \left[\begin{array}{cccc} 2 & 1 & -1 & 2 \\ 0 & -5 & -5 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & -1 & 2 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_1 - 2r_3 \rightarrow r_3} \left[\begin{array}{cccc} 2 & 1 & -1 & 2 \\ 0 & -5 & -5 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 1 & -2 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_2 - 5r_3 \rightarrow r_2} \left[\begin{array}{cccc} 2 & 1 & -1 & 2 \\ 0 & -5 & -5 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -10 & 10 \end{array} \right]$$

$$\begin{array}{c} x \quad y \quad z \quad \text{const}^+ \\ \left[\begin{array}{cccc} 2 & 1 & -1 & 2 \\ 0 & -5 & -5 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -10 & 10 \end{array} \right] \end{array} \rightarrow$$

$$2x + y - z = 2$$

$$-5y - 5z = 0$$

$$-10z = 10 \rightarrow z = -1$$

$$-5y - 5(-1) = 0$$

$$-5y + 5 = 0$$

$$y = 1$$

$$2x + (1) - (-1) = 2$$

$$2x + 2 = 2$$

$$x = 0$$





Example:

$$3x + 2y = 5$$

$$6x + 4y = 8$$

Solve

$$\begin{bmatrix} 3 & 2 & 5 \\ 6 & 4 & 8 \end{bmatrix}$$



$$\begin{bmatrix} 3 & 2 & 5 \\ 6 & 4 & 8 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$2r_1 - r_2 \rightarrow r_2$$

$$\begin{array}{c} x \quad y \quad \text{const} \\ \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 2 & 5 \\ 0 & 0 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \end{array}$$

$$3x + 2y = 5$$

$$0x + 0y = 2 \Rightarrow$$

$$0 = 2$$

